Evolution Questions

1) Carefully read the passage below and answer the questions that follow.

When an animal dies, the soft parts of its body decay leaving the hard parts such as bones and teeth. Tiny holes and spaces develop in the bone. Minerals work their way into it and gradually replace it and a fossil is formed. There are other kinds of fossils, such as footprints, which become covered by mud and harden into rock. In other cases a mould is produced when a dead organism becomes buried in mud. The organism decays leaving a space (or mould) which shows the shape of the organism. Another method is where animals have become covered by a natural preservative which stops them decaying e.g. amber, ice and tar. From these fossils scientists can work out what the animals looked like.

a) Which part of the organism remains after the soft parts have decayed? (1 mark)

b) Give an example of a "soft part" of an animal. (1 mark)

c) Explain how a mould is produced.
(1 mark)

d) Give **two** examples of natural preservatives (2 marks)

e) What use is made of the information which is obtained from fossils? (1 mark)

f) Only a tiny fraction of the organisms which have died have become fossilised. Suggest a possible reason for this.
(1 mark)

g) Suggest a reason why animals become extinct.
(1 mark)

h) Name **one** example of:

A long extinct species
(1 mark)
A more recently extinct species (1 mark)